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Learning Objectives

At the end of this lesson you shall be able to

- Explain disaster and its types.
- Explain the causes, effects and precautions to be taken on various disasters.

8.1 Introduction

Disaster is a sudden extreme, calamitous event bringing great damage, loss to life and property. The damage caused by disasters is immeasurable and varies with the geographical location, climate and type of the earth surface. This influences the mental, socio-economic, political and cultural state of the affected area. Generally disaster has the following effects in the concerned areas,

- It completely disrupts the normal day to day life
- It negatively influences the emergency systems
- Normal needs and processes like food, shelter, health, etc., are affected and deteriorate depending on the intensity and severity of the disaster.

8.2 Types of disaster

Generally, disasters are of two types –

- Natural disaster
- Man-made disaster

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